

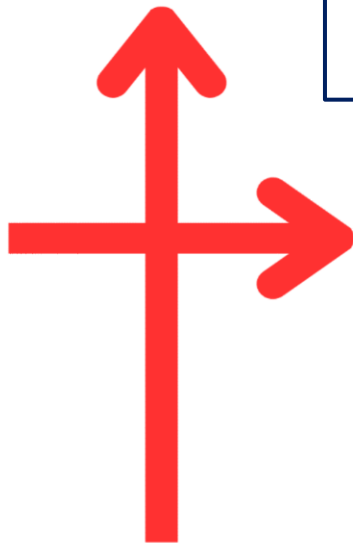
THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

*Ps Barry's
Reflections on:*
**PRAYER,
PROCLAMATION and
PERSONAL PROGRESS**

*Bethel Global Missions
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THE VERTICAL & HORIZONTAL DIMENSIONS in the life of Believers & Local Church (Series 1.)

In this reflection I thought it is appropriate to present in a three-part series the following three important principles or dimensions affecting the individual and the local church congregation.

They are:

1. **THE VERTICAL & HORIZONTAL DIMENSION** in the life of the individual and the local church
2. **THE RADIC & CENTRIC MENTALITIES** of the individual and the local Church
3. **THE THREE DIMENSIONS OF MINISTRY** to the lord, to one another & to the world!

FOR THIS WEEK'S STUDY LET US LOOK AT

THE VERTICAL AND HORIZONTAL DIMENSION

THE VERTICAL DIMENSION

The vertical dimension  refers to GOD and the believer being in right relationship with God through Christ's redemptive work on the cross justifying us – imparting to us his righteousness as a gift.

JUSTIFICATION

- WE HAVE **RIGHT STANDING** WITH GOD BECAUSE HE JUSTIFIED US – DECLARED US RIGHTEOUS.

- * **Right standing with God** means that God is no longer angry with us – he has established peace between himself and the believer – forgiven, reconciled and accepted into his family

Romans 4:25 [Jesus] He was delivered over to death for our sins and was raised to life for our justification. NIV

Romans 3:28 For we maintain that a man is justified by faith apart from observing the law. NIV
Romans 5:1 Therefore, since we are justified (acquitted, declared righteous, and given a right standing with God) through faith, let us [grasp the fact that we] have [the peace of reconciliation to hold and to enjoy] peace with God through our Lord Jesus Christ (the Messiah, the Anointed One). AMP

Galatians 3:11 Now it is clear that no one is justified before God by the law, because the righteous will live by faith. Holman Bible

- * However, there are many people who through all kinds of religious observances and human self-effort seeking to find God, to experience his acceptance and being able desiring to freely approach him.
- * **BUT IT IS IMPOSSIBLE TO KNOW GOD THROUGH HUMAN WISDOM.**
 1 Corinthians 1:21 Since God in his wisdom saw to it that the world would never know him through human wisdom, he has used our foolish preaching to save those who believe. NLT
 1 Corinthians 1:21 in view of the fact that, in the wisdom of God, the world system through its wisdom did not come to have an experiential knowledge of God, God saw fit through the aforementioned foolishness of the previously alluded to proclamation to save those who believe. WUEST
Galatians 3:11 Clearly no one is justified before God by the law, because, "The righteous will live by faith." NIV

ALL SINNERS

- * But God has declared that all are sinners and have come short of God's righteousness and scheduled for judgement and eternal separation from God.

JUSTIFIED BY FAITH

- * However, through repentance and believing on Christ Jesus' atoning death we are brought into right relationship with God – where we can fellowship with him without the fear, guilt or shame
 Romans 5:1 Therefore, since we have been justified through faith, we have peace with God through our Lord Jesus Christ, NIV
 Romans 3:28 For we maintain that a man is justified by faith apart from observing the law. NIV
 Galatians 3:24 So the law was put in charge to lead us to Christ that we might be justified by faith. NIV
- **THERE CAN BE NO VERTICAL DIMENSION, NO RELATIONSHIP OR FELLOWSHIP WITH GOD WITHOUT JUSTIFICATION.**
- * If, there is no justification, then there is no relationship and therefore there can be no fellowship with God.
- * **FELLOWSHIP WITH GOD IS DEPENDENT UPON BEING IN RIGHT RELATIONSHIP WITH HIM THROUGH HIS JUSTIFYING OF US – i.e. declaring us righteous.**
 1 John 1:3 We proclaim to you what we have seen and heard, so that you also may have fellowship with us. And our fellowship is with the Father and with his Son, Jesus Christ. NIV
- * **FELLOWSHIP WITH THE FATHER IS CONDITIONAL ON OUR WALKING IN THE LIGHT OF GOD'S COMMANDS WHICH IS GODLINESS – i.e. GODLY LIVING**
 1 John 1:6 If we claim to have fellowship with him yet walk in the darkness, we lie and do not live by the truth. NIV
- **JUSTIFICATION IS THE VERTICAL DIMENSION THAT MUST BE IN PLACE BEFORE ANY HORIZONTAL DIMENSION IS POSSIBLE –**

NOW WE COME TO:

- **THE HORIZONTAL DIMENSION** 
- * **THIS DIMENSION RELATES TO THE RELATIONSHIP AND FELLOWSHIP THAT WE HAVE WITH ONE ANOTHER.**

1 John 1:3 We proclaim to you what we have seen and heard, so that you also may have fellowship with us. And our fellowship is with the Father and with his Son, Jesus Christ. NIV

- **How is our personal relationship to our brethren?**
- **How would you describe it?**
- **What kind of fellowship do we have or with our fellow brothers and sisters**

A QUESTION?

- Has there been something happen in your Christian life that has affected your relationship and fellowship with someone?
- Has unforgiveness or resentment related some past offence or hurt remained unresolved in us that has affected our relationship with people in general?
- Or has our reluctance to seek to some form of resolution or reconciliation caused us from having a good proper relationship with a brother or sister or maybe with the church?
- * **THE PRESENCE OF THE HORIZONTAL DIMENSION IN RESPECT OF HAVING GOOD RELATIONSHIPS WITH OUR BROTHERS AND SISTER AND IS SOMETHING THAT GOD CONSIDERS TO BE ABSOLUTELY ESSENTIAL.**
- * **Therefore, it is binding upon all of us to seek to maintain right relationships with one another which may at times mean endeavoring to reconcile to say sorry, forgive in order to restoring relationships. Amen Ps Barry**